

Polenta with white beans and sun-dried tomatoes

Simple luxury epitomizes what polenta is all about: the most basic of flavors, properly cooked—no more, no less. This recipe highlights that idea with a combination of soft white beans and the appeal of slightly chewy and tangy sun-dried tomatoes. For best results, serve this dish fresh from the pot, when the polenta is warm and soft. However, if you make it into firm cakes and reheat them the next day, you'll still have yourself a fine dish. Serve with a side of cooked or fresh greens.

1 recipe Basic Polenta (page 216)

3 garlic cloves, minced

1½ ounces sun-dried tomatoes [45g]

2 cups cooked white beans [330g]

1 tablespoon olive oil

Salt and freshly ground pepper

1 small onion, finely chopped

1. **Prepare** the Basic Polenta and keep warm in a double boiler.
2. Soak the sun-dried tomatoes in 1 cup [250ml] hot water until soft, 15 to 20 minutes. Drain, reserving ½ cup [125ml] of the soaking liquid. **Cut** the tomatoes into thin strips.
3. In a large skillet, **heat** the olive oil over medium-low heat. Add the onion and cook for 3 to 5 minutes, until soft and translucent. Add the garlic and sun-dried tomatoes and cook for an additional 30 seconds. Increase the heat slightly and add the reserved soaking liquid. Cook for 1 to 2 minutes, stirring frequently, until the liquid cooks reduces and the sauce thickens.
4. Add the beans and heat through for 2 minutes. **Season** with salt and pepper to taste and set aside on the stovetop.

5. **Pour** individual servings of hot polenta into bowls. Make a well in the center of each with a ladle and spoon in the white beans and sauce. Serve immediately.

SERVES 4

note This dish serves 6 as an appetizer.

